Assignment 4: Vital Signs Report

Systolic Blood Pressure (SBP) is a vital sign that measures the pressure exerted on arterial walls when the heart contracts during ventricular systole. In adults, a normal SBP range is typically around 90-120 mmHg. SBP below 90 mmHg is considered abnormal and indicates hypotension, which may be associated with reduced circulating blood volume, dehydration, sepsis, or cardiac dysfunction, with values around or below 70 mmHg indicating severe circulatory failure and possible shock. SBP above 140 mmHg is also abnormal and indicates hypertension, while readings of 180 mmHg or higher are classified as a hypertensive crisis and are associated with a significantly increased risk of complications such as stroke, myocardial infarction, and organ damage. In clinical practice, SBP is a key observation used in patient assessment and triage, helping nurses rapidly identify patients who are deteriorating and prioritise urgent treatment based on abnormal readings.

Source:

National Library of Medicine. (n.d.). Pulse oximetry: Understanding its limitations in clinical practice. PubMed Central. https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC1124431/